

How You Learn Best — Biology

This is about how you learn, what helps the room work, and what you need from me. Answer honestly. It takes about 15 minutes, and your answers shape the plan I build for you. — Mr. Schwebach

About you

1. Your first and last name.
2. What is something you are good at or care about outside this class? (A sport, a job, music, a game, helping at home, anything.)

How you learn best

There are no right answers here. Your answers decide how your lessons get built.

3. When I am learning something new in biology, it helps most when... (choose up to 3)

- A. Mr. Schwebach explains it at the front while I follow along
- B. I fill in blanks on a page as he explains
- C. I read it on my own first, then we talk about it
- D. I work it out with a partner or a small group
- E. I see a drawing or diagram, or draw it myself
- F. I move around or act it out (like the Human Membrane)
- G. I look at something real (a microscope slide, a model)
- H. I practice questions and find out right away if I got them right

4. How do you feel about the class packet?

- A. I love it. It is how I keep track of everything.
- B. It works for me most of the time.
- C. It is okay, but I get lost in it.
- D. I do not like it.

5. How much of the block do you want Mr. Schwebach at the front explaining?

- A. Most of the block
- B. About half, then we work
- C. A short explanation, then mostly working
- D. Very little. I would rather figure it out.

6. Rank the kinds of notes by how well they help you remember. Put your top 3 in order, with 1 as the one that helps most.

- A. Fill-in-the-blank notes
- B. Copying a drawing as it is drawn
- C. Writing it in my own words
- D. Card sorts and matching
- E. Talking it through with someone

7. When the class works through one packet page together, what makes it easier to follow? (choose all that apply)

- A. The slide matches the page exactly
- B. He says the page number out loud

- C. The slide stays up long enough to copy
- D. Blanks to fill in instead of open space
- E. Nobody is talking while he explains
- F. I already follow fine

8. Which of these have helped you learn this year? (choose all that apply)

- A. Word card sorts
- B. Drawing cells along with Mr. Schwebach
- C. The Human Membrane
- D. Mystery Cells
- E. The microscope (the seaweed slide)
- F. Practice quizzes on Canvas that show feedback
- G. Crosswords
- H. CER one-pagers
- I. A printed copy of a reading
- J. Gizmos

9. Pick one thing from that list that did NOT help you. What got in the way?

10. Which do you want MORE of? (choose up to 3)

- A. Word card sorts
- B. Drawing cells along with Mr. Schwebach
- C. The Human Membrane
- D. Mystery Cells
- E. The microscope (the seaweed slide)
- F. Practice quizzes on Canvas that show feedback
- G. Crosswords
- H. CER one-pagers
- I. A printed copy of a reading
- J. Gizmos
- K. Mr. Schwebach explaining at the front
- L. Small group work
- M. Labs and hands-on work

11. Is there anything else you would like more of that is not on that list? (Optional)

12. Do you learn better from paper or from the iPad?

- A. Paper
- B. iPad
- C. Both the same
- D. It depends on the task

13. How easy is it to find what we are doing today on Canvas (the Start Here page)?

- A. Very easy
- B. Okay
- C. Hard
- D. I do not use it

14. After a practice quiz on Canvas, do you read the feedback on the questions you missed?

- A. Always
- B. Sometimes

- C. Rarely
- D. I did not know there was feedback

15. When you get stuck, what do you usually do?

- A. Raise my hand and wait
- B. Ask the person next to me
- C. Look back in the packet or Canvas
- D. Skip it and come back later
- E. Call out the question
- F. Stop working

16. How do you feel about the pace of this advanced class?

- A. Too fast
- B. About right
- C. Too slow
- D. It depends on the topic

One voice at a time

For the whole class to get through a page together, one voice has to carry the lesson at a time. Small group work is where everyone gets to talk.

17. When Mr. Schwebach is teaching from the front, I follow best when the room is:

- A. Silent
- B. Quiet, with whispered help from a partner
- C. Some talking is fine

18. How often does someone talk over the lesson in this class?

- A. Almost every class
- B. Some classes
- C. Rarely
- D. Never

19. Be honest: in a typical class, how many times do you talk while someone else has the floor?

- A. 0
- B. 1 or 2
- C. 3 to 5
- D. More than 5

20. When you talk during the lesson, it is usually because... (choose all that apply)

- A. I have a question and do not want to forget it
- B. I am helping a friend who is lost
- C. I already know it or I am bored
- D. I am tired, and talking keeps me awake
- E. Someone talked to me first
- F. I did not notice I was doing it
- G. I rarely talk during the lesson

21. What would help you hold a question until the right moment?

- A. Writing it on my page and asking during work time
- B. A set question pause every 10 minutes or so

- C. A sticky note I hand in or leave on my desk
- D. Emailing it to Mr. Schwebach after class
- E. I would rather ask right away

22. When is the best time for you to talk with Mr. Schwebach one-on-one?

- A. During small group work
- B. Before the bell
- C. At the end of class
- D. After school
- E. By email

23. What helps your small group get work done? (choose all that apply)

- A. A clear job for each person
- B. A time limit
- C. Choosing my own group
- D. Groups picked by Mr. Schwebach
- E. Something to turn in at the end
- F. A checklist of steps

24. In a group, which role do you usually take?

- A. Organizer (keeps us on track)
- B. Explainer
- C. Writer or recorder
- D. Checker (makes sure it is right)
- E. I let others lead
- F. It depends

25. If your group stays on task, would you like more say in how it works (choosing roles, the order of tasks, how to show what you learned)?

- A. Yes
- B. Maybe
- C. No, just tell us what to do

26. By the time this class meets, how is your energy?

- A. Ready to go
- B. Okay
- C. Tired
- D. Exhausted

27. On a school night, about how many hours do you usually sleep?

- A. Less than 6
- B. 6 to 7
- C. 7 to 8
- D. 8 to 9
- E. More than 9

28. On a typical school day, how many hours do you spend after school on a sport, job, club or caring for family?

- A. None
- B. Less than 1 hour
- C. 1 to 2 hours

- D. 2 to 3 hours
- E. More than 3 hours

29. When you are tired, what helps you most? (choose all that apply) A quiet break with your head down is allowed. Talking over the lesson is not.

- A. A few minutes of quiet with my head down
- B. Standing up or moving around
- C. A hands-on task
- D. Working with a partner
- E. Short, clear steps
- F. Water or a stretch

30. What is one thing classmates could do to make this room better for learning? Do not name anyone.

31. What is one thing YOU will do to make this room better for learning?

32. To learn in here, I need Mr. Schwebach to...

Canvas, the packet and where the lesson is going

Canvas is changing to help you keep track of where to work in your packet. Each Start Here page now names the packet page and the slide for every step, and the slide map jumps straight to the slide that matches your page. The county is rolling out new technology practices this year and expects every class to use them. Start Here pages, practice quizzes with feedback and your iPad are how this class meets those requirements.

33. Does the Start Here page help you know which packet page to work on?

- A. Yes, every time
- B. Most of the time
- C. Sometimes
- D. No
- E. I have not used it

34. Does the Start Here page help you see where the lesson is going (what comes next and what it builds toward)?

- A. Yes
- B. Somewhat
- C. No
- D. I have not used it

35. In Unit 2 (cells), the slides, the packet and Canvas lined up with each other better than in Unit 1. Do you agree?

- A. Strongly agree
- B. Agree
- C. Not sure
- D. Disagree
- E. Strongly disagree

36. People learn in different ways. Does having each step on Canvas let classmates who learn differently from you work through the content their own way?

- A. Yes
- B. Somewhat
- C. No
- D. Not sure

37. Before today, did you know the county is requiring classes to use these new technology practices?

- A. Yes
- B. I had heard something about it
- C. No

38. You can always email Mr. Schwebach an idea for the class instead of saying it out loud during the lesson. How likely are you to do that?

- A. I already have
- B. Likely
- C. Maybe
- D. Unlikely

Speaking up without calling attention to yourself

Do not write anyone's name in this section. If you want to report something, share an idea or give me feedback without anyone noticing, you have three ways: write it on a slip of paper and hand it to me at the end of class, talk with me privately, or email me. Every message gets read.

39. Have you seen another student cheating in this class (copying, sharing answers, using a phone or AI on a quiz or test)?

- A. Yes, more than once
- B. Yes, once
- C. No
- D. Not sure

40. Are phones being used in class where Mr. Schwebach cannot see them because of how the room is set up?

- A. Yes, often
- B. Sometimes
- C. Rarely
- D. No
- E. Not sure

41. Where in the room is it hardest for Mr. Schwebach to see what is going on?

- A. Back lab benches
- B. By the sinks
- C. Near the door
- D. A corner
- E. Not sure

Home and getting back on track

42. What is the best way for Mr. Schwebach to share good news about you with your family?

- A. Email to my parent or guardian
- B. A phone call
- C. A note I carry home
- D. Tell me first, and I will tell them

43. If you got off track in class, which of these would help you reset fastest?

- A. A private reminder
- B. Writing it down myself

- C. A short talk with Mr. Schwebach after class
- D. A call home
- E. Not sure

44. Is there anything Mr. Schwebach should know that would help you learn in this class? (Optional)